

PAT PARKER



Where Will You Be?

Boots are being polished
Trumpeters clean their horns
Chains and locks are forged
The crusade has begun.

Once again flags of Christ
are unfurled in the dawn
and cries of soul saviors
sing apocalyptic on air waves.

Citizens, good citizens all
parade into voting booths

and in self-righteous sanctity
X away our right to life.

I do not believe as some
that the vote is an end,
I fear even more
It is just a beginning.

So I must make assessment
Look to you and ask:
Where will you be
when they come?

They will not come
a mob rolling
through the streets,
but quickly and directly
move into our homes
and remove the evil,
the queerness,
the faggotry,
the perverseness
from their midst.
They will not come
clothed in brown,
and swastikas, or
bearing chest heavy with
gleaming crosses.
The time and need
for ruses are over.

They will come
in business suits
to buy your homes
and bring bodies to
fill your jobs.

They will come in robes
to rehabilitate
and white coats
to subjugate
and where will you be
when they come?

Where will we *all* be
when they come?
And they will come—

they will come
because we are
defined as opposite—
perverse
and we are perverse.

Every time we watched
a queer hassled in the
streets and said nothing—
It was an act of perversion.

Every time we lied about
the boyfriend or girlfriend

at coffee break—
It was an act of perversion.

Every time we heard,
“I don’t mind gays
but why must they
be blatant?” and said nothing—
It was an act of perversion.

Every time we let a lesbian mother
lose her child and did not fill
the courtrooms—
It was an act of perversion.

Every time we let straights
make out in our bars while
we couldn’t touch because
of laws—
It was an act of perversion.

Every time we put on the proper
clothes to go to a family
wedding and left our lovers
at home—
It was an act of perversion.

Every time we heard
“Who I go to bed with
is my personal choice—
It’s personal not political”

and said nothing—
It was an act of perversion.

Every time we let straight relatives
bury our dead and push our
lovers away—
It was an act of perversion.

And they will come.
They will come for
the perverts
& it won't matter
if you're
 homosexual, not a faggot
 lesbian, not a dyke
 gay, not queer

It won't matter
if you
 own your own business
 have a good job
 or are on SSI

It won't matter
if you're
 Black
 Chicano
 Native American
 Asian
 or White

It won't matter
if you're from
 New York

or Los Angeles
Galveston
or Sioux Falls

It won't matter
if you're

Butch, or Fem
Not into roles
Monogamous
Non Monogamous

It won't matter
if you're

Catholic
Baptist
Atheist
Jewish
or MCC.

They will come
They will come
to the cities
and to the land
to your front rooms
and in *your* closets.

They will come for
the perverts
and where will
you be
When they come?